

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 8

Reviewing Progress & Introducing Imagery Rescripting for Core Beliefs

Fictional Educational Example — Full Detailed

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	RK (35 y/o Male)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	8 of 16	Focus:	Progress review + Imagery for core beliefs

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client has made excellent progress. Belief in the old perfectionistic thought is now around 25-30%. Behavioral experiments continue to be highly effective. Today we will do a mid-therapy progress review, introduce **Imagery Rescripting** to further weaken the core belief from childhood, and plan the focus for the second half of therapy.

SESSION START & PROGRESS REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, RK. We're now at Session 8 — the halfway point. Before we dive into new work, let's take stock of how far you've come. When we started, your GAD-7 was 18 and your belief in "I have to be perfect..." was around 80%. Where are they now?

Client: GAD-7 is down to about 7-8. And the old belief is around 25-30%. I feel much calmer at work and I'm sleeping better. My wife has also noticed I'm less irritable and more present at home.

Therapist: That's a very significant improvement. What has contributed most to these changes?

Client: The behavioral experiments have been the biggest thing. Actually testing my fears in real life has changed how I think. Worry Time and the new balanced belief have also helped a lot.

INTRODUCING IMAGERY RESCRIPTING FOR CORE BELIEFS

Therapist: Since we've been working on the core belief that started in childhood, I'd like to introduce a technique called **Imagery Rescripting**. It uses mental imagery to revisit and change the emotional meaning of early memories that fuel the belief. It can be very powerful for beliefs that feel deeply rooted.

Client: That sounds interesting but also a bit intense. How does it work?

Therapist: We'll start by recalling a specific childhood memory where you felt you had to be perfect to be accepted. Then we'll "rescript" it — meaning we imagine the scene again, but this time with a different, more compassionate and realistic ending that supports your new belief. You stay in control the whole time.

Client: Okay, I'm willing to try if you guide me through it.

(Therapist guides a brief, safe imagery rescripting exercise based on a childhood memory of feeling pressure to perform perfectly. Client imagines a more compassionate adult version of himself or a supportive figure intervening. The exercise is kept gentle and contained.)

Therapist: How do you feel after that exercise?

Client: It was emotional but helpful. I felt like I could give that younger version of me permission to not be perfect. It made the new belief feel more real.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue daily diary + Worry Time / Postponement
2. Practice the new balanced belief and rate the old one daily
3. Do one more behavioral experiment focused on your remaining fear
4. Write a short letter from your "compassionate adult self" to your younger self about not needing to be perfect (we can review it next session)

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your strong progress and introduced Imagery Rescripting to work on the emotional roots of the belief. The exercise seemed to land well with you. What stood out most?

Client: The imagery exercise was powerful. It helped me feel more compassionate toward myself. I'm also really encouraged by how much my scores have improved.

Therapist: That's great to hear. Any questions?

Client: No, I'm clear on the homework.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Excellent mid-therapy progress review. Client has made substantial gains.
- Imagery Rescripting was well-tolerated and appeared helpful for emotional processing of the core belief.
- Client showing increased self-compassion and reduced belief in old rule.

- Next session: Review imagery letter and new experiments, continue consolidation, begin more explicit relapse prevention planning.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.